

THE COMPLETE GRIEF RECOVERY WORKBOOK

Process, Heal & Find Meaning After Loss

Daniel Tesfamariam

THE COMPLETE GRIEF RECOVERY WORKBOOK

Copyright Daniel Tesfamariam. All rights reserved.

UNDERSTANDING GRIEF

Grief is not stages. It is waves.

Some days the waves are gentle. Some days they knock you down. Both are normal. Both are grief.

There is no timeline. There is no 'getting over it.'
There is only learning to carry it differently.

Types of loss acknowledged in this workbook:

- Death of a loved one
- End of a relationship
- Loss of health or ability
- Loss of a dream or future
- Loss of identity or role
- Loss of safety or trust

All grief is valid. Your loss matters.

MY GRIEF PROFILE

What/who I lost: _____

When: _____

How it happened: _____

How it changed me:

What I miss most:

What feels unfinished:

My grief style: ☐ Intuitive (emotional) ☐ Instrumental (action)

☐ Mix of both

THE GRIEF TIMELINE

Map your relationship story:

How we met/began:

Happiest memory:

Hardest moment together:

Last good memory:

The loss itself:

First days after:

First month:

Where I am now:

UNFINISHED BUSINESS

Things I wish I had said:

Things I wish I had done:

Things I wish they knew:

Apologies I need to make or receive:

What I need to forgive (them or myself):

Dear _____,

I want you to know...

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue or grey ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are approximately 20 lines visible. The paper has a slight shadow on its right side, suggesting it's resting on a surface.

PROCESSING ANGER

My anger is directed at:

What feels unfair:

What my anger is protecting me from:

Healthy ways to express it:

Letter to my anger:

PROCESSING GUILT

I feel guilty about:

Was this actually in my control?

What I would tell a friend feeling this guilt:

Evidence I did my best with what I knew:

Self-forgiveness statement:

PROCESSING REGRET

My biggest regret:

Can I change this now?

If no, can I accept it?

What I learned from this:

How I'll honor this lesson going forward:

FINDING MEANING

(Viktor Frankl: meaning doesn't explain loss, it helps us survive it)

What meaning am I making from this loss?

How has this changed my values?

What do I want my life to stand for now?

How can I honor what I lost?

CONTINUING BONDS

Ways I maintain connection:

Rituals I keep:

How I talk about them:

Items I treasure:

How I feel their presence:

CREATING NEW RITUALS

Birthday ritual:

Anniversary/death date:

Holiday traditions:

Daily small ritual:

Memorial/legacy project:

IDENTITY RECONSTRUCTION

Who I was before:

Who I am now:

Who I am becoming:

Roles that have changed:

New strengths I've discovered:

DAY 1

Date: ____/____/____

Grief wave intensity (1-10): ____

What triggered it: _____

What helped: _____

One thing I'm grateful for: _____

One way I honored them: _____

DAY 2

Date: ____/____/____

Grief wave intensity (1-10): ____

What triggered it: _____

What helped: _____

One thing I'm grateful for: _____

One way I honored them: _____

DAY 3

Date: ____/____/____

Grief wave intensity (1-10): ____

What triggered it: _____

What helped: _____

One thing I'm grateful for: _____

One way I honored them: _____

DAY 4

Date: ____/____/____

Grief wave intensity (1-10): ____

What triggered it: _____

What helped: _____

One thing I'm grateful for: _____

One way I honored them: _____

DAY 5

Date: ____/____/____

Grief wave intensity (1-10): ____

What triggered it: _____

What helped: _____

One thing I'm grateful for: _____

One way I honored them: _____

DAY 6

Date: ____/____/____

Grief wave intensity (1-10): ____

What triggered it: _____

What helped: _____

One thing I'm grateful for: _____

One way I honored them: _____

DAY 7

Date: ____/____/____

Grief wave intensity (1-10): ____

What triggered it: _____

What helped: _____

One thing I'm grateful for: _____

One way I honored them: _____

DAY 8

Date: ____/____/____

Grief wave intensity (1-10): ____

What triggered it: _____

What helped: _____

One thing I'm grateful for: _____

One way I honored them: _____

DAY 9

Date: ____/____/____

Grief wave intensity (1-10): ____

What triggered it: _____

What helped: _____

One thing I'm grateful for: _____

One way I honored them: _____

DAY 10

Date: ____/____/____

Grief wave intensity (1-10): ____

What triggered it: _____

What helped: _____

One thing I'm grateful for: _____

One way I honored them: _____

DAY 11

Date: ____/____/____

Grief wave intensity (1-10): ____

What triggered it: _____

What helped: _____

One thing I'm grateful for: _____

One way I honored them: _____

DAY 12

Date: ____/____/____

Grief wave intensity (1-10): ____

What triggered it: _____

What helped: _____

One thing I'm grateful for: _____

One way I honored them: _____

DAY 13

Date: ____/____/____

Grief wave intensity (1-10): ____

What triggered it: _____

What helped: _____

One thing I'm grateful for: _____

One way I honored them: _____

DAY 14

Date: ____/____/____

Grief wave intensity (1-10): ____

What triggered it: _____

What helped: _____

One thing I'm grateful for: _____

One way I honored them: _____

DAY 15

Date: ____/____/____

Grief wave intensity (1-10): ____

What triggered it: _____

What helped: _____

One thing I'm grateful for: _____

One way I honored them: _____

DAY 16

Date: ____/____/____

Grief wave intensity (1-10): ____

What triggered it: _____

What helped: _____

One thing I'm grateful for: _____

One way I honored them: _____

DAY 17

Date: ____/____/____

Grief wave intensity (1-10): ____

What triggered it: _____

What helped: _____

One thing I'm grateful for: _____

One way I honored them: _____

DAY 18

Date: ____/____/____

Grief wave intensity (1-10): ____

What triggered it: _____

What helped: _____

One thing I'm grateful for: _____

One way I honored them: _____

DAY 19

Date: ____/____/____

Grief wave intensity (1-10): ____

What triggered it: _____

What helped: _____

One thing I'm grateful for: _____

One way I honored them: _____

DAY 20

Date: ____/____/____

Grief wave intensity (1-10): ____

What triggered it: _____

What helped: _____

One thing I'm grateful for: _____

One way I honored them: _____

DAY 21

Date: ____/____/____

Grief wave intensity (1-10): ____

What triggered it: _____

What helped: _____

One thing I'm grateful for: _____

One way I honored them: _____

DAY 22

Date: ____/____/____

Grief wave intensity (1-10): ____

What triggered it: _____

What helped: _____

One thing I'm grateful for: _____

One way I honored them: _____

DAY 23

Date: ____/____/____

Grief wave intensity (1-10): ____

What triggered it: _____

What helped: _____

One thing I'm grateful for: _____

One way I honored them: _____

DAY 24

Date: ____/____/____

Grief wave intensity (1-10): ____

What triggered it: _____

What helped: _____

One thing I'm grateful for: _____

One way I honored them: _____

DAY 25

Date: ____/____/____

Grief wave intensity (1-10): ____

What triggered it: _____

What helped: _____

One thing I'm grateful for: _____

One way I honored them: _____

DAY 26

Date: ____/____/____

Grief wave intensity (1-10): ____

What triggered it: _____

What helped: _____

One thing I'm grateful for: _____

One way I honored them: _____

DAY 27

Date: ____/____/____

Grief wave intensity (1-10): ____

What triggered it: _____

What helped: _____

One thing I'm grateful for: _____

One way I honored them: _____

DAY 28

Date: ____/____/____

Grief wave intensity (1-10): ____

What triggered it: _____

What helped: _____

One thing I'm grateful for: _____

One way I honored them: _____

DAY 29

Date: ____/____/____

Grief wave intensity (1-10): ____

What triggered it: _____

What helped: _____

One thing I'm grateful for: _____

One way I honored them: _____

DAY 30

Date: ____/____/____

Grief wave intensity (1-10): ____

What triggered it: _____

What helped: _____

One thing I'm grateful for: _____

One way I honored them: _____

SUPPORT & HEALING

MY SUPPORT NETWORK:

Name: _____ How they help: _____

Name: _____ How they help: _____

Name: _____ How they help: _____

Name: _____ How they help: _____

WHEN GRIEF IS COMPLICATED (seek help if):

- Unable to function after 6+ months
- Suicidal thoughts
- Substance use to cope
- Complete inability to feel joy
- Persistent disbelief the loss occurred

MY HEALING DECLARATION:

I am healing. This is what that looks like for me:
